

Face-saving disagreement

Front card: the field move

Core move
Save the person before you challenge the point: truthful bridge, precise disagreement, workable next step.

Formula
Face bridge + specific difference + shared criterion + dignified next step.

Avoid when
Immediate safety, required escalation, bad faith, or when the bridge would be fake.

Minimum viable phrase
I can see why that read makes sense. I see one part differently; [specific point].

Use when
A disagreement may threaten dignity, status, competence, public standing or belonging.

Field tip
Respect the person; narrow the difference; keep the next step workable.

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Back card: calibration, recovery and chain

Calibration
Continue if they inspect the point. Recover if they defend status, go silent, or hear personal criticism.

Boundary phrase
I understand the ask. I cannot agree to that. What I can do is [alternative].

Main mistake
Over-cushioning until the disagreement disappears.

Recovery
I am not questioning your intent or effort. I am challenging this part of the plan.

Neighbour split
Use TC092 when face is threatened; use TC005 for validation only; use SBI for behaviour feedback.

Chain
TC014 -> TC092 -> trade-off clarification or clean request; then pause.